

Academic Two-Column Paper

Abstract. This paper studies text extraction from multi-column documents. Reading order is the central challenge because glyphs are stored in drawing order, not logical order. A naive concatenation interleaves the two columns and destroys meaning. We evaluate a coordinate-based reconstruction heuristic.

Method. We group text items by their vertical position into lines, then detect a large horizontal gap that separates the left column from the right column. Each column is emitted in full before moving to the next, restoring a natural top-to-bottom, left-to-right reading order for downstream translation.